

Htet Myat Aung

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Mechanistic interpretability and neurosymbolic AI: evaluating whether language models form genuine abstractions or memorise surface patterns, and how capability interacts with scaffolding to determine that.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science (Artificial Intelligence)

Sep 2025 – Jun 2028

Royal Holloway, University of London

Egham, UK

- Year 1 average **74% (First Class)**; Mathematical Methods **94%**. **ISC Excellence Scholarship** holder.
- Coursework: Mathematical Methods, Algorithms & Complexity, Machine Fundamentals, Logic & Reasoning.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Fellow (UROP, funded)

Jun 2026 – Present

DICE Lab, Royal Holloway — Prof. Kostas Stathis & Dr. Agnieszka Mensfelt

Selected: 8 of 30+ applicants

- Investigating **LLM autoformalization**: translating VacuumWorld agent percepts into Prolog knowledge bases, and measuring whether models induce general boundary-wall rules or hardcode enumerated facts.
- Designed and ran a **nine-model × four-prompt-condition sweep** (zero-shot, instruction, schema, one-shot), with a composition table isolating each scaffolding factor as a single-variable contrast.
- Built a **nine-constraint symbolic evaluator** and an F1-vs- N grid-size sweep to separate true rule induction from enumeration that only appears correct at small N .
- Found a **capability × scaffolding interaction**: model tier sets the abstraction ceiling, scaffolding determines whether a model reaches it. Identified DeepSeek-V3 as a frontier outlier with persistent partial hardcoding.
- Diagnosed and patched an evaluator bug silently zeroing scores on rule-based outputs, and documented a prompt confound in the condition design — both corrected the headline results.
- Outputs: full technical report (Sep 2026); submissions targeted at the **NeurIPS Interpretability workshop** and **AAAI Student Abstract** track.

Research Software Contributor

2026

DICE Lab Autoformalization Paper Catalogue

Royal Holloway

- Built dataset filters and CI/CD pipelines (TypeScript) for the lab's public catalogue of autoformalization literature, used to triage papers for ongoing survey work.

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Early Engineer

2026 – Present

Sharper Future Ltd

Remote, UK

- Early technical hire shipping production features across the stack with LLM APIs and evaluation tooling; contract includes an IP carve-out preserving independent university research.

PROJECTS

- **MyanLearn** — Burmese literacy platform on Cloudflare Workers AI, with users across 18+ countries.
- **MyanPay** — Voice-driven cross-border payments prototype (Claude API, Groq Whisper, Hedera), built at the LSE Agentic Society Hackathon.
- **Interpretability groundwork** — Reimplementing Karpathy's micrograd from scratch, as groundwork for transformer-internals research.
- **ML portfolio** — NASA near-Earth-object hazard classifier; MobileNetV2 transfer-learning classifier.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Prolog (SWI), TypeScript/JavaScript, Java, $\LaTeX$

ML & research: PyTorch, NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, matplotlib; experiment design, evaluation-harness construction, LLM API pipelines (Anthropic, OpenAI, DeepSeek, open-weight models)

Tools: Git, GitHub Actions/CI, Linux, Cloudflare Workers

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

Secretary, RHUL AI & Robotics Society (2025–26) · **Technology Officer**, RHUL Neuroscience Society (2025–26)

ISC Excellence Scholarship, Royal Holloway International Study Centre · Member of **Mensa**